

OS Lab 3

AIM: Introduction to the OS, shell, and processes in general.

Run a few simple programs (as processes on your Linux machine), and monitor their behavior using the proc file system.

TO DO:

- Understand the proc file system of linux.

Search for “man proc” on web for information.

Understand the stat and status files of a process, and the system wide files of the proc directory.

- Learn “top” command in LINUX (tells you information about processes and their resource consumption)

“ps” command tells you information about all processes in the system. ps has several useful commandline arguments. It is worthwhile understanding and learning the most useful ones. For example, ps -A gives you information about all processes in the system.

Also, learn to use any disk monitoring tool. For example, “iostat” gives you information about disk utilization. Again, understanding various useful commandline arguments (-c -x -m etc.) will be quite handy.

Exercise:

Do the following exercises, and record your observations in your report.

1. Collect the following basic information about your machine using proc. How many CPU cores does the machine have? How much memory, and what fraction of it is free? How many processes has it forked since bootup?